

D572

Career and Lifelong Learning

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A healthcare administration student who volunteers at an animal shelter writes this goal after a career workshop held in the campus library: "Earn my Certified Professional in Healthcare Quality credential by passing the exam before December 31 next year, studying 5 hours a week." Is this a SMART goal?

- A. No; it is not relevant because she volunteers with animals.
- B. No; it is missing a deadline.
- C. No; goals must be under 10 words to be SMART.
- D. Yes; it is specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

"I want to get better at leadership soon." Which revision fixes the most SMART elements?

- A. "Get better at leadership by June 30."
- B. "I really want to become a great leader."
- C. "Lead two project team meetings a month and complete a leadership course by June 30."
- D. "Become CEO within six months."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A clinic coordinator who commutes by bike is revising her résumé. Her current bullet reads "Responsible for scheduling patients." She redesigned the scheduling template in the spring, and no-show rates fell from 18% to 11% over six months. Her clinic has a rooftop garden. Which bullet is strongest?

- A. "Responsible for scheduling patients and managing the calendar."
- B. "Hard-working, detail-oriented team player."
- C. "Redesigned the patient scheduling template, cutting no-show rates from 18% to 11% in six months."
- D. "Reduced no-shows by 18%."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A bullet reads “Cut supply costs by 15%, saving \$24,000 a year.” What were the original annual supply costs?

- A.** \$160,000
- B.** \$136,000
- C.** \$27,600
- D.** \$3,600

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A job seeker who recently moved to a coastal city applies online to a posting that lists “revenue cycle management,” “Epic,” and “claims denial reduction.” His résumé is a two-column design with icons, and it describes his work as “billing operations.” He has 9 years of experience. What change would most improve his chance of passing the initial screen?

- A.** Use a simple format and, where accurate, use the posting’s terms such as “revenue cycle management” and “claims denial reduction.”
- B.** Add more icons and color to stand out.
- C.** List every keyword from the posting, even skills he lacks.
- D.** Lead with his 9 years, since experience always outweighs keywords.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

An interviewer at a hospital with a new parking garage asks, “Tell me about a time you resolved a conflict on your team.” The candidate, who once lived abroad, spends most of the answer describing the team’s history and ends with “and we worked it out.” What is the main weakness?

- A.** She should have given a hypothetical answer instead.
- B.** She gave mostly Situation and skipped her own Actions and a concrete Result.
- C.** She should have mentioned her time abroad.
- D.** She should have described the team’s history in even more detail.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sentence is the Result portion of a STAR answer?

- A.** “My job was to fix the handoff problem.”
- B.** “I met with both shift leads and drafted a shared handoff checklist.”
- C.** “Our night and day shifts kept missing information at handoff.”
- D.** “Within a month, handoff errors dropped by half and the two shifts began sharing a checklist.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A career changer who enjoys woodworking gets a 20-minute informational interview with a hospital data analyst she met at a neighbor’s barbecue. The analyst works on the fifth floor. What is the best use of the conversation?

- A.** Skip it, since only close friends provide useful job leads.
- B.** Hand over a résumé and leave after five minutes.
- C.** Ask directly for a job opening on the analyst’s team.
- D.** Ask about the analyst’s path, daily work, and advice, and whether there is anyone else she should talk to.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A former restaurant manager who plays in a softball league is applying for a patient services supervisor role. He trained 15 new staff, handled customer complaints, and built weekly schedules. The restaurant was known for its barbecue. How should he present this experience?

- A.** Emphasize his technical knowledge of barbecue cooking.
- B.** As transferable skills—training, service recovery, and scheduling—mapped to the supervisor duties.
- C.** List them as technical healthcare skills.
- D.** Leave it off, since restaurant work is unrelated to healthcare.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A graduate who loves hiking compares two offers. Offer A: \$75,000 salary, no bonus, 2% retirement match. Offer B: \$70,000 salary, 8% annual bonus, 5% retirement match. Offer A's office is closer to a state park. Assuming she earns the full bonus and contributes enough to get the full match, which offer has higher total annual cash-plus-match compensation, and by how much?

- A.** Offer A, because it is closer to the park.
- B.** Offer B, by \$2,600.
- C.** Offer B, by \$9,100.
- D.** Offer A, by \$5,000.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Offer C has no bonus and a 4% retirement match. What salary would give it the same salary-plus-match total as \$79,100?

- A.** \$79,100
- B.** About \$82,264
- C.** About \$76,058
- D.** About \$75,936

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A student who grew up on a cattle ranch takes an interest inventory. She most enjoys helping, teaching, and counseling people, and least enjoys working with machines or detailed records. Her favorite color is teal. Which RIASEC type best fits her interests?

- A.** Social.
- B.** Realistic, because she grew up on a ranch.
- C.** Enterprising.
- D.** Conventional.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A healthcare administration student ~~who volunteers at an animal shelter~~ writes this goal after a career workshop ~~held in the campus library~~: “Earn my Certified Professional in Healthcare Quality credential by passing the exam before December 31 next year, studying 5 hours a week.” Is this a SMART goal?

Target word: judge a goal against SMART **Decides:** Specific outcome, measurable pass, weekly plan, relevant, dated.

A	Camouflage	Her volunteer work does not make a healthcare credential irrelevant.
B	Dropped element	It has one: December 31 next year.
C	Absolute language	Length is not a SMART criterion.
D	Correct	Names the credential, the measure (pass), a realistic plan, relevance to the field, and a deadline.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

“I want to get better at leadership soon.” Which revision fixes the most SMART elements?

Target word: repair a vague goal **Decides:** Adds specific action, measure, and date.

A	Dropped element	Adds a date but still lacks a measure.
B	Inverted operation	Makes the goal more inspiring but no more specific or measurable.
C	Correct	Specific actions, countable measures, and a deadline.
D	Adjacent category	Time-bound but not achievable for most people.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A clinic coordinator ~~who commutes by bike~~ is revising her résumé. Her current bullet reads “Responsible for scheduling patients.” She redesigned the scheduling template in the spring, and no-show rates fell from 18% to 11% over six months. ~~Her clinic has a rooftop garden.~~ Which bullet is strongest?

Target word: strongest accomplishment statement **Decides:** Action verb plus quantified result.

A	Dropped element	A duty statement with no result.
B	Adjacent category	Self-description belongs in neither a bullet nor a result.
C	Correct	Starts with an action and shows a measurable result.
D	Wrong stem number	The drop was 7 percentage points (18% to 11%), not 18%.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A bullet reads “Cut supply costs by 15%, saving \$24,000 a year.” What were the original annual supply costs?

Target word: solve for the baseline **Decides:** $\$24,000 = 15\%$ of the original.

A	Correct	$\$24,000 / 0.15 = \$160,000$.
B	Inverted operation	That is the new cost after the cut, not the original.
C	Dropped element	Adds 15% to the savings instead of treating the savings as 15% of the original.
D	Wrong stem number	Multiplies \$24,000 by 15% instead of dividing.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A job seeker ~~who recently moved to a coastal city~~ applies online to a posting that lists “revenue cycle management,” “Epic,” and “claims denial reduction.” His résumé is a two-column design with icons, and it describes his work as “billing operations.” ~~He has 9 years of experience.~~ What change would most improve his chance of passing the initial screen?

Target word: ATS tailoring **Decides:** Posting terms missing and a hard-to-parse format.

A	Correct	Tracking systems match terms and parse simple layouts best.
B	Inverted operation	Graphics often break automated parsing.
C	Absolute language	Tailoring must stay truthful; false claims fail at interview.
D	Camouflage	Years alone do not help if the screen cannot match terms.

6. Answer B Concept 4

An interviewer at a hospital ~~with a new parking garage~~ asks, “Tell me about a time you resolved a conflict on your team.” The candidate, ~~who once lived abroad~~, spends most of the answer describing the team’s history and ends with “and we worked it out.” What is the main weakness?

Target word: STAR gap **Decides:** Too much Situation; no personal Action or concrete Result.

A	Adjacent category	Behavioral questions ask for real past examples.
B	Correct	STAR answers should center on what the candidate did and what changed.
C	Camouflage	Unrelated to the conflict question.
D	Inverted operation	More background worsens the imbalance.

7. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

Which sentence is the Result portion of a STAR answer?

Target word: identify a STAR part — reverse direction **Decides:** The measurable outcome.

A	Dropped element	That is the Task; it names the goal without the outcome.
B	Confusion set	That is the Action.
C	Adjacent category	That is the Situation.
D	Correct	States the outcome.

8. Answer D Concept 5

A career changer ~~who enjoys woodworking~~ gets a 20-minute informational interview with a hospital data analyst she met at a neighbor’s barbecue. ~~The analyst works on the fifth floor.~~ What is the best use of the conversation?

Target word: purpose of an informational interview **Decides:** Gather insight and build a relationship.

A	Absolute language	Weak ties often supply new information and leads.
B	Dropped element	Drops the conversation that makes the meeting valuable.
C	Inverted operation	Turns an information meeting into a job request and can damage trust.
D	Correct	Insight and referrals are the goal; relationships grow from there.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A former restaurant manager ~~who plays in a softball league~~ is applying for a patient services supervisor role. He trained 15 new staff, handled customer complaints, and built weekly schedules. ~~The restaurant was known for its barbecue.~~ How should he present this experience?

Target word: transferable skills **Decides:** Training, complaint resolution, and scheduling carry across industries.

A	Camouflage	An industry-specific skill that does not transfer.
B	Correct	These skills apply directly to supervising patient services.
C	Confusion set	They are transferable, not healthcare-specific technical skills.
D	Absolute language	Ignores skills that transfer across industries.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A graduate ~~who loves hiking~~ compares two offers. Offer A: \$75,000 salary, no bonus, 2% retirement match. Offer B: \$70,000 salary, 8% annual bonus, 5% retirement match. ~~Offer A's office is closer to a state park.~~ Assuming she earns the full bonus and contributes enough to get the full match, which offer has higher total annual cash-plus-match compensation, and by how much?

Target word: compare total compensation **Decides:** $A = 75,000 + 1,500 = 76,500$; $B = 70,000 + 5,600 + 3,500 = 79,100$.

A	Camouflage	Location is a preference, not compensation.
B	Correct	$\$79,100 - \$76,500 = \$2,600$.
C	Wrong stem number	Adds B's bonus and match to the \$5,000 salary gap instead of netting them against it: $\$5,600 + \$3,500 = \$9,100$.
D	Dropped element	Compares salaries only and drops bonus and match.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

Offer C has no bonus and a 4% retirement match. What salary would give it the same salary-plus-match total as \$79,100?

Target word: solve for salary **Decides:** $\text{Salary} \times 1.04 = \$79,100$.

A	Dropped element	Drops the match, which adds to total compensation.
B	Adjacent category	Adds 4% instead of removing it.
C	Correct	$\$79,100 / 1.04 \approx \$76,058$.
D	Inverted operation	Subtracts 4% of \$79,100 instead of dividing by 1.04.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A student ~~who grew up on a cattle ranch~~ takes an interest inventory. She most enjoys helping, teaching, and counseling people, and least enjoys working with machines or detailed records. ~~Her favorite color is teal.~~ Which RIASEC type best fits her interests?

Target word: RIASEC type **Decides:** Helping, teaching, counseling.

A	Correct	Social types prefer helping and teaching others.
B	Camouflage	Background does not set her stated preferences; she dislikes machines.
C	Adjacent category	Enterprising involves persuading and leading for goals, not helping and teaching.
D	Inverted operation	She least enjoys detailed records, the core of Conventional.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	8	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SMART career goals	A useful goal is Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.	Calling an inspiring but vague goal SMART.	A goal with no number, date, or clear outcome.
2	Accomplishment statements	Strong résumé bullets start with an action verb and show a result, ideally quantified, rather than listing duties.	Writing “responsible for ...” duty lists.	A bullet that says what you did but not what changed.
3	Tailoring for applicant tracking systems	Many employers screen résumés with applicant tracking systems, so each résumé should mirror the posting’s key terms (truthfully) in a simple, readable format.	Sending one generic, graphics-heavy résumé to every job.	A posting with specific skill terms and an online application portal.
4	STAR interview answers	Behavioral interview answers follow Situation, Task, Action, Result, with most of the time on the candidate’s own actions and a concrete result.	Spending the answer on background and saying “we” instead of what you did.	“Tell me about a time when ...”
5	Networking and informational interviews	Informational interviews gather insight and build relationships rather than ask for a job; many opportunities come through weak ties (acquaintances) who connect you to new information.	Using an informational interview to ask directly for a job, or relying only on close friends.	A short conversation with someone working in a target field.
6	Transferable vs. technical skills	Transferable skills (communication, problem solving, leadership) carry across roles and industries; technical skills are specific to a tool, field, or job.	Discounting experience from a different industry as irrelevant.	A career changer mapping past experience to a new role.
7	Comparing total compensation	Compare offers by total compensation—salary plus bonus, retirement match, and other benefits—not by base salary alone.	Choosing the higher base salary without adding the other pay elements.	Offers that differ in salary, bonus, and match.
8	Person-environment fit (RIASEC)	Holland’s RIASEC model links interest types—Realistic, Investigative, Artistic, Social, Enterprising, Conventional—to work environments; better fit tends to predict satisfaction.	Using the model as a strict test of ability rather than a guide to interests.	A person’s preferred activities matched to career types.

Course scope (public description): Career and Lifelong Learning supports students in taking their first steps in a lifelong journey of development as a professional. Students will explore career pathways, plan how best to achieve their desired professional future, and take tangible steps toward that future by creating career growth materials that adhere to today’s best practices. There are no prerequisites for this course.